

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Owner for complex digital manufacturing environments.*

Positioning, product owner with ten years translating operational complexity into backlog-ready requirements, now applying that to manufacturing and quality digitisation.

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§ WHY THIS ENGAGEMENT

A heterogeneous system landscape serving production, quality, lab, and supply chain simultaneously is exactly the environment where backlog discipline and clear stakeholder translation make or break delivery. The posting names a recurring challenge directly: rising domain requirements that must be aligned to business goals, not just technical tickets. That is the hard problem I have solved at Rohde & Schwarz, at Emil Group, and at the Federal Employment Agency – each time in a setting where incomplete requirements, competing priorities, and integration complexity were the baseline. The combination of Operational Excellence pressure with regulatory quality constraints is a familiar axis. *That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

Direct experience in chemical industry production processes, MES, LIMS, or batch manufacturing systems is not part of my career history. What I do bring is demonstrated product ownership in equally complex, regulated, and safety-critical environments: defence AI data infrastructure under FCAS, public-sector compliance and data lineage at the Federal Employment Agency, and InsurTech platform governance where audit and validation requirements were non-negotiable. The transferable mechanic is the same: map complex

operational workflows, translate them into dev-ready requirements, and maintain delivery velocity under regulatory constraint.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting and stakeholder document generation
 - **GPT**, backlog refinement, user story structuring, edge-case generation
 - **GitHub Copilot**, in-sprint development support and acceptance-criteria tooling
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, spec-driven feature work and rapid prototyping
 - **Gamma.app**, workshop decks and stakeholder communication
 - **Jira / Confluence**, backlog management, sprint ceremonies, documentation
 - **Power BI / MicroStrategy**, KPI tracking and reporting product ownership
 - **n8n**, workflow automation and integration prototyping
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Jenkins, Bitbucket, GitOps pipelines, Python, Django, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, AngularJS, Ionic, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redpanda, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, REST APIs, Microsoft Azure-compatible cloud and hybrid architectures, Jira, Confluence, Microsoft Teams.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTEST ENGINE & AGENT FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Self-built crypto backtesting engine and agentic dev framework, combining infrastructure-level crypto knowledge with autonomous workflow design.

- Implements a backtesting engine for crypto markets with configurable strategy logic and execution simulation.
- Architecture uses file-queue-based agent loops for autonomous task orchestration, aligned with n8n and Replit-based tooling.
- Built iteratively alongside trading bot development and multi-venue execution analysis.

- Demonstrates the same autonomous, end-to-end delivery model applied in professional roles – relevant for any posting requiring a PO who can engage directly with engineering at implementation depth.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT THIS COMPANY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Interview key stakeholders across production, quality, and IT to map the current system landscape, surface the highest-friction integration points, and audit the existing backlog for clarity and business-value alignment.

WEEK 2

Prioritise, slice, validate.

Run a structured backlog refinement with domain leads to reorder items by business risk and value, break down ambiguous epics into sprint-ready user stories, and align on a short-horizon roadmap that production and IT can commit to.

WEEK 3+

Ship, close, improve.

Drive the first sprint cycle through to accepted deliverables, establish KPI tracking for product usage and process improvement, and open the feedback loop with production floor stakeholders to feed the next roadmap iteration.

I COVER LETTER

The engagement description identifies a specific structural problem: a heterogeneous system landscape that has grown faster than the governance around it, with rising domain requirements and insufficient alignment between business goals and the product roadmap. That is not a technology problem. It is a product ownership problem, and it is one I have solved repeatedly.

At Emil Group, I inherited a 17-person team with collapsed sprint discipline, a backlog that no one trusted, and a client base on the verge of disengaging. Within weeks I restructured the team into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and ran weekly product workshops that rebuilt stakeholder confidence. Delivery stabilised. Senior

developer attrition dropped from near-total to a single departure. The mechanism was the same one this engagement requires: clear ownership, disciplined prioritisation, and the ability to translate domain complexity into work that engineers can act on.

At Rohde & Schwarz, the domain was AI data infrastructure for a multinational defence programme. The regulatory and quality requirements were stringent, the stakeholder landscape was international and interdisciplinary, and the system had to satisfy both technical auditability and operational transparency. I delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end, from user stories through implementation support to GitOps rollout, and unblocked infrastructure-level issues that had been sitting unresolved for over a year. That is the combination of depth and pragmatism this role calls for.

At the Federal Employment Agency, I served simultaneously as product manager for a public analytics platform and as deputy IT security officer, managing compliance, data lineage, and governance alongside feature delivery. I introduced Dagster for automated ETL pipelines, migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes, and maintained delivery continuity across major system upgrades. Working at the intersection of operational systems, data quality, and regulatory constraints is familiar ground for me.

The nice-to-have items in this posting – regulated environments, quality and process knowledge, KPI-based steering, integration complexity – are not gaps I need to bridge. They are the conditions I have worked in across three consecutive roles. I do not have chemical industry background specifically, and I have named that honestly. What I bring instead is a demonstrated ability to enter a complex domain, build credibility with operational stakeholders quickly, and deliver product outcomes under exactly the kind of pressure this engagement describes.

I am available on four weeks' notice, fluent in German and English, and comfortable with the remote/on-site split indicated. I look forward to discussing the engagement in detail.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Senior Product Owner and Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience governing complex digital products in regulated, operationally critical environments. Proven track record of owning product vision, roadmap, and backlog across cross-functional stakeholder landscapes in defence, public sector, and enterprise SaaS. Equally comfortable translating domain requirements from production-floor experts and IT architects into sprint-ready deliverables, and

driving KPI-based product improvement after go-live. Brings founder-level pragmatism, strong backlog discipline, and the technical fluency to engage engineering teams at implementation depth.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Translating complex operational requirements into dev-ready user stories
 - Backlog management, sprint discipline, and velocity governance
 - Cross-functional stakeholder alignment across business, IT, and operations
 - Product ownership in regulated and audit-sensitive environments
 - Workshop moderation with technical and non-technical participants
 - KPI-oriented product steering and continuous improvement
 - Integration and system landscape complexity management
 - End-to-end feature delivery including test, acceptance, and rollout
 - Founder-level ownership and pragmatic prioritisation under pressure
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Owned product vision, roadmap, and backlog for a business-critical AI data management platform under a multinational defence programme (FCAS) with strict quality and auditability requirements
- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout via ArgoCD
- Improved data quality through filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and full audit trails with data provenance – directly analogous to quality and traceability requirements in regulated manufacturing
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature that had been pending from engineering for over a year
- Led cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA; managed multinational stakeholders

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Governed roadmap and delivery for the Arbeitsmarktmonitor, a public analytics platform serving regional labour market and demographic data
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV): responsible for compliance, governance, and data lineage – equivalent to regulated-environment quality requirements
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; standardised CI/CD with full test integration
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades without service disruption
- Designed interactive dashboards, reporting features, and admin tooling using MicroStrategy and dbt

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Owned backlog and delivery for a B2B InsurTech platform with complex configuration, underwriting, policy, document management, and workflow modules – a heterogeneous enterprise system landscape with multiple stakeholder groups
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Restructured a bloated 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units; reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure through ownership clarity and delivery stability

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Built a mobile-first pilot app for hospitals across iOS and Android covering digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system (KIS) workflows – integration complexity between operational and business systems
- Managed tight delivery timelines with transparent stakeholder communication of technical constraints (legacy APIs, external databases)

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Co-Founder and Product Owner

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product (one-time-pad keys, true random number generator hardware) with a two-minute setup target and no technical knowledge required from the end user
- Served as deputy IT security officer; responsible for attack vector mitigation and compliance architecture
- English-language product promotion: youtube.com/watch?v=nt06f71lgfE

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder and CFO

- Founded and built a group-based P2P payments product on a P2P backbone; owned PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype
- Product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO, CFO, Head of HR (successive roles)

- Built digital tooling, financial planning, and ERP infrastructure for a nanotechnology startup in vertical farming
- Led investor relations and business development across multiple funding rounds

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · FREELANCERMAP (AUFTRAGGEBER → ANONYM)